



Send a Message

One script can start another with a message

Name: _____

Date: _____

★ I can read a broadcast message that starts another script.

Broadcast and receive

A script can send a message to other scripts. This is called a broadcast. Bit's last block is 'broadcast go'. Pixel's script starts with 'when I receive go'. So Bit runs first, sends the message 'go', and THAT message starts Pixel. Pixel waits until it hears 'go'.

The number path



Bit

Bit's script

when green flag clicked

forward 2

broadcast 'go'



Pixel

Pixel's script

when I receive 'go'

back 2

1 Bit goes first

The green flag starts Bit from home 0: forward 2. What number does Bit land on? Then Bit sends the message 'go'.

2 Pixel hears the message

When Pixel receives 'go', it runs from home 5: back 2. What number does Pixel land on?

3 What starts Pixel?

Pixel has no green-flag block. What makes Pixel's script start? Write it. Would Pixel move if Bit never sent the message? Circle YES or NO.

Big idea

A broadcast is a message one script sends. A 'when I receive' script waits for that message and starts when it arrives. So Bit's broadcast 'go' is the EVENT that starts Pixel — no message, no start.



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Quick facilitation notes & answer key

What this worksheet teaches

Students meet sending and getting a message: Bit can send a message ("go"), and Pixel starts only when it gets that message ("when I receive go"). The message is itself an event. No coding experience needed.

Before you start (no computer needed)

No computer needed — paper and a pencil. You read the prompts aloud. Optional: two counters on a number line 0 to 5 (green Bit, purple Pixel), and a card that says "go" you can hand over to act out sending a message.

How to lead it (about 20 minutes)

1. Show them (you do). Bit runs, then sends "go"; Pixel was waiting for "go" and starts only then.
2. Do one together. Exercise 1 — Bit lands on 2 and sends "go"; Exercise 2 — Pixel gets "go" and lands on 3.
3. Let them try. Students name what starts Pixel, and say what happens if "go" is never sent (Ex 3).

Answer key (these are the verified correct answers)

Exercise 1 — Bit: 0, forward 2 → 2, then sends "go".

Exercise 2 — Pixel gets "go" and runs: 5, back 2 → 3.

Exercise 3 — Pixel is started by the message ("when I receive go"). If Bit never sent "go", Pixel would not move — it stays home at 5.

If students get stuck — and ways to adjust

Watch for: thinking the green flag starts Pixel. It is the message that starts Pixel.

Make it easier: hand a "go" card to the child running Pixel to act out the message.

Make it harder: ask why Pixel runs after Bit, not at the same time (the message is sent at the end of Bit's moves).

Ontario curriculum link (official wording)

C3.1 — solve problems and create computational representations of mathematical situations by writing and executing code, including code that involves sequential and concurrent events.

In plain terms: students write and run instructions that are started by an event, like clicking the green flag or getting a message.

C3.2 — read and alter existing code, including code that involves sequential and concurrent events, and describe how changes to the code affect the outcomes.

In plain terms: students read instructions, change what starts them or one move, and explain what the change did.

You'll know it worked when

The child sees that Pixel runs only because Bit sent the message, and finds both landings.